CLIFFCO

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Uniondale, NY 11553

Brand guidelines.

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WHO WE ARE

We make the mortgage process *clear*.

For more than 37 years, Cliffco has helped families buy, refinance and invest by cutting through the noise that usually surrounds a mortgage. You get straight answers, real numbers, and one loan officer who handles your file from the first click through funding.

CLEAR

Plain answers and real numbers, with nothing tucked into the fine print.

SIMPLE

Fewer steps and no guesswork about what happens next.

PERSONAL

One loan officer who knows your file and answers your call.

FAST

An application that takes minutes and a team that keeps every deal moving.

Our vision

Our vision is to lead as the nation's most innovative and talent-nurturing firm, setting the benchmark for simplicity and collaboration in every partnership.

Our mission

To transform the dream of homeownership into reality while elevating the net worth and self worth of the families and team members we serve.

Our values

PERSONALIZATION
We love to create WOW

TEAMWORK
We are stronger together

INTENTIONALITY
We are present and aligned in our relationships

EMPOWERMENT
We ignite personal responsibility

INTEGRITY
We act with unwavering honesty

ACCOUNTABILITY
We hold ourselves to a standard of predictable excellence

ACHIEVEMENT
We celebrate the wins

GROWTH
We cultivate success for our clients and our team

SECURITY
We protect everyone we work with

INNOVATION
We blaze the trail in a changing world

Our voice

Clear, direct, personal

Cliffco speaks the way the brand looks: clean, confident and uncluttered. We tell people what they need to know in the order they need to know it, and we leave out anything that doesn't help them make a decision. The writing stays warm because there's a real loan officer behind every file, but it never pads a message to sound friendly.

We lead with the answer

Whether it's a number, a next step or a requirement, the useful part comes first and the context follows after.

We show the numbers

Specific rates, payments, dates and requirements build more trust than adjectives do, so when we can show the figure, we show it along with the disclosure that goes with it.

We keep it conversational

Familiar words do most of the work. When an industry term can't be avoided, we explain it in the same sentence so nobody has to look it up.

Voice in practice

	INSTEAD OF	WE WRITE
01 LEAD WITH THE ANSWER	We're thrilled to offer an amazing variety of competitive mortgage products!	Here are the three loan options that fit your income and down payment, with the monthly payment for each.
02 EXPLAIN THE TERM	Your DTI exceeds the guideline threshold for this product.	Your monthly debts are a little high for this loan compared with your income, so we're looking at two other options that could work.
03 SHOW THE NUMBER	Rates are at historic lows, so lock in today before it's too late!	Rates change daily. This example uses a 6.75% rate as of July 21 and is for illustration only.
04 BE SPECIFIC ABOUT NEXT STEPS	A member of our dedicated team will be in touch shortly.	Your loan officer will call tomorrow afternoon to go over your documents.

TAGLINES

The mortgage process should be black and white.

Click. Funded.

Clarity and simplicity that cuts through the noise.

The brand line leads headline placements such as the website hero, campaign openers and presentation covers. “Click. Funded.” is set in IBM Plex Mono on its own, and in Archivo capitals inside the marketing lockup.

BRAND VOICE

How we sound

BE		DON’T BE	
Clear	✓	Wordy	×
Direct	✓	Vague	×
Specific	✓	Hype-Driven	×
Concise	✓	Jargon-Filled	×
Confident	✓	Pushy	×
Warm	✓	Cold	×
Transparent	✓	Overpromising	×
Conversational	✓	Exclamation-Heavy	×

Black, white and one blue

The palette stays in black, white and gray so the one blue has something to stand against. Sky is a light, clear blue that reads as calm and open, and it only works because everything around it is neutral.

BLACK · PRIMARY

HEX #0D0D0D
RGB 13, 13, 13
CMYK 74, 67, 66, 85

Headlines, body text, the plate and the secondary pages. Use the rich black build for large printed areas and 100% K for small type.

WHITE · PRIMARY

HEX #FFFFFF
RGB 255, 255, 255
CMYK 0, 0, 0, 0

Every page background, so the black type and the Sky box carry the message.

Supporting colors

SKY · ACCENT

HEX #BDE8F1
RGB 189, 232, 241
CMYK 22, 0, 5, 0

One word in one box per piece, and the studio forms on pages 29–31. The CMYK is a starting build; match a spot color from a printed swatch book.

GRAPHITE · PANELS

HEX #3D4040
RGB 61, 64, 64
CMYK 69, 60, 60, 47

Caption panels, cards on black and secondary fields.

SOFT GRAY · BODY ON BLACK

HEX #B3B2B4
RGB 179, 178, 180
CMYK 31, 25, 24, 0

Body copy, labels and name lines on black, so headlines stay the brightest thing on the page.

AIRY GRAY · LIGHT SURFACE

HEX #F0EEF1
RGB 240, 238, 241
CMYK 5, 4, 2, 0

Document panels and alternate light surfaces.

COLOR

Color in use

White does most of the work and black carries the words. Sky is a sliver, and if a layout looks like it has more blue than that, it does.

APPROXIMATE BALANCE



Photography brings its own color on the website and in print. On social, photos run in black and white until the one color moment described on page 26.

CONTRAST

PAIR	RATIO	USE
White on Black	19.4:1	Headlines, wordmark
Soft Gray on Black	9.2:1	Body copy, labels
White on Graphite	10.5:1	Caption panels; Sky on Graphite 8.0:1
Black on Sky	14.8:1	The Sky box; Sky on black in studio
Black on White	19.4:1	Documents
Graphite on White	10.5:1	Body text on white

THE SKY BOX

One word in a Sky box

The caption is the brand's signature: bold Archivo, two to six words, with exactly one word set in black on a Sky box. It's what makes a post, a flyer and a video cover read as Cliffco, and Sky is reserved for it.

1. The boxed word is the payoff: the verb, the number or the thing being promised, never "the" or "and."
2. The box is the word's own line box, 1.1 × the type size tall, with 0.15–0.2 em on each side. Square corners, no stroke, no shadow.
3. One box per cover, post, poster or slide. Two highlighted words cancel each other.

× Text inside the box is always black. Sky is never a text color on white, and never on buttons, icons, charts, borders or the logo.

We make financing **simple**

× TWO HIGHLIGHTED WORDS

Fast answers, **real** people

× WHITE TEXT IN THE BOX

We make financing **simple**

The logo is the name

Cliffco has no symbol. The logo is the name in Archivo Bold capitals at the SemiExpanded width with wide tracking, held in a solid plate. The plate gives the name the weight of a stamp, and on black the plate drops away so the white letters stand alone.

Typeface	Archivo 700 Bold, width 112.5% (SemiExpanded)
Tracking	+200 (0.2 em) at every size
Case	Always capitals
Plate	0.6 em above and below, 1.15 em on each side
Files	Place the supplied artwork; re-set the type only to build something new



DASHED LINE · CLEAR SPACE OF ONE CAP HEIGHT

Versions



Primary. The black plate on white or Airy Gray, used everywhere it fits.



On black. White on black, for dark surfaces and over graded photos.



Reversed. Black letters with no plate, only when the surface must stay white and space is tight.

Lockups

Each lockup keeps the plate unchanged and adds one line of Archivo Medium capitals at about half the wordmark's size, tracked +240.

CLIFFCO

MORTGAGE BANKERS

Mortgage Bankers. Formal and regulatory materials, letterhead and disclosures.

CLIFFCO

CLICK. FUNDED.

Click. Funded. Marketing, advertising and the website header.

FINANCED BY

CLIFFCO

MORTGAGE BANKERS

Financed by. Partner stamp for agents' and builders' posts and co-branded flyers. Partners place the file; they never retype it.

The icon

CMB, the initials of Cliffco Mortgage Bankers, in a square plate. It replaces the full logo anywhere it would be under 96 px wide: the favicon, social avatars and app tiles.

CMB

ON BLACK

CMB

ON WHITE

CMB

SOCIAL AVATAR

CMB Cliffco Mortgage

FAVICON · 16–32 PX

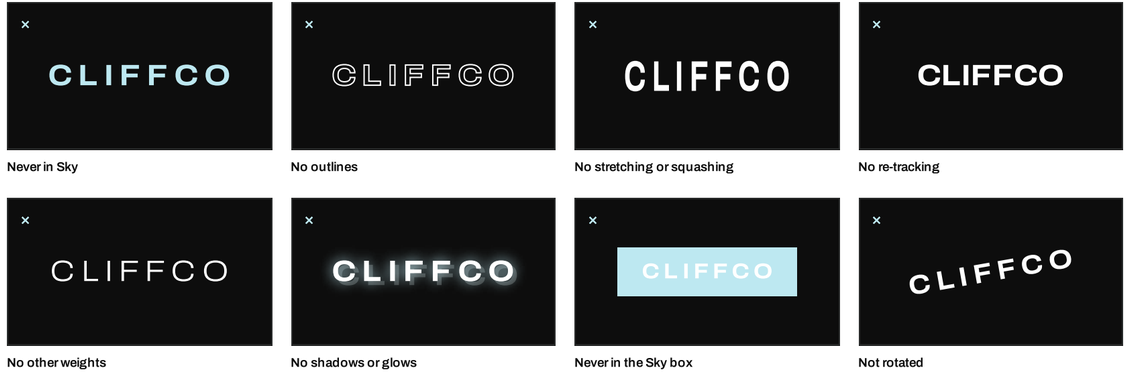
Size and clear space

Keep one cap height clear on every side of the plate, and measure from the letters when the wordmark stands alone on black. Nothing enters that space, including text, photo edges and other logos.

MARK	MINIMUM
Wordmark or plate	96 px · 0.75 in
Lockups	160 px · 1.25 in
Icon	32 px · 0.375 in
Favicon	16 px



Never



TYPOGRAPHY · PRIMARY

Archivo

Archivo sets the logo and everything you read: headlines, captions, body copy, labels and buttons. Its width axis lets the wordmark run at SemiExpanded while all other text stays at the normal width. It's free on Google Fonts and available in Canva.

Nothing lighter than 400 and nothing heavier than 800, and no Archivo italics. The brand's only italic is Instrument Serif.

Aa

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz 0123456789

Regular 400	Body copy and labels
Medium 500	Name lines and lockup text
Bold 700	Headlines, captions, the wordmark
ExtraBold 800	Large display headlines only

TYPOGRAPHY · SUPPORTING

Two faces with narrow jobs

Aa Aa

Instrument Serif

The display accent. Regular in tall Sky capitals for the studio name, and Italic for a guest's name, a title card, or one word inside a large headline. It never sets body copy, captions or the logo.

Welcome *home.*

Aa

IBM Plex Mono

The data voice. Rates, payments and other figures, name tags, slide numbers, episode footers and the "Click. Funded." tagline. It never sets a sentence or a headline.

$219,600 · 6.75%

TYPOGRAPHY

Roles

ROLE	FACE · WEIGHT	CASE · TRACKING	COLOR	NOTES
Wordmark	Archivo 700 · 112.5%	CAPS · +0.2 em	White or Black	The logo
Caption	Archivo 700	Title Case · –0.025 em	White or Black, one Sky box	2 to 6 words
Headline	Archivo 700–800	Sentence case · –0.02 em	White	Page, slide and section titles
Body	Archivo 400	Sentence case · 0	Soft Gray on black, Black on white	Max 66 characters a line
Label	Archivo 500	CAPS · +0.2 em	Soft Gray	Eyebrows, sublines, footers
Display	Instrument Serif 400	CAPS or Italic	Sky (on black) or White	Studio name, guest name, one word
Figure · Tag	IBM Plex Mono 500–700	As written or CAPS	White	Numbers, name tags, footers

Screen scale. Display 96–200 px, caption 72–110 px at 1080 wide, H1 48–64, H2 32–40, body 16–18, labels 12–13.

Print scale. H1 30–36 pt, H2 18–22 pt, body 9.5–10.5 pt on 14 pt leading, labels 7–8 pt. Nothing under 9 pt reversed out of black.

INTERFACE

Buttons, fields and cards

Buttons are black and white only. Sky stays in the caption box, so it never competes with the call to action.

BUTTONS

Get Pre-Qualified

Call (800) 834-4040

Apply Now

Contact Us

FORM FIELD

Gross monthly income ($)

8,000

Before taxes and deductions

RESULT CARD

MAX HOME PRICE · EXAMPLE

$219,600

DOWN PAYMENT
$40,000

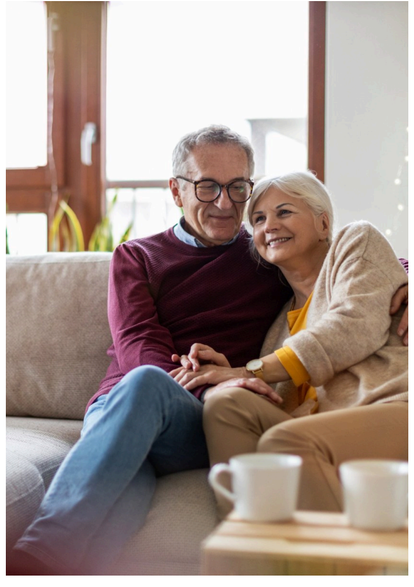
MONTHLY
$1,845

Square corners throughout, to match the plate and the Sky box. Borders are 1 px in the line gray on black, or 1.5 px in white for secondary buttons.

Real people, natural light

On the website, in print and in email, photography runs in full color. Choose natural light, real homes and offices, and people in the middle of something genuine, like talking through numbers at a kitchen table or settling into a new home.

Avoid staged handshakes, key handovers and overly corporate stock. Photos have square corners and can run off the edge of the page.

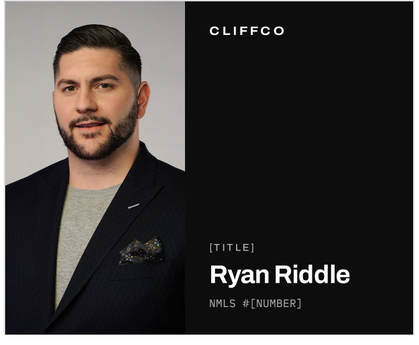




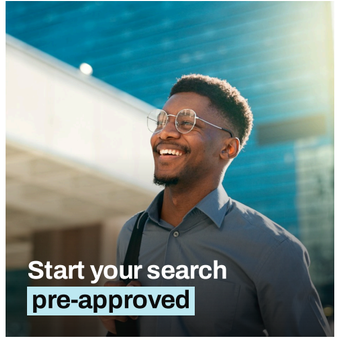
HEADSHOTS

Chest up against a plain light gray backdrop with soft, even light and a natural expression, always in full color.

Photos with the brand



Team profiles
The headshot beside a black panel with name, title and NMLS number.



Caption on photography
The caption sits lower left over the darkest part of the photo.



Logo on photography
The white wordmark top right, over a calm area with a light black gradient where needed.

PHOTOGRAPHY ON SOCIAL

Black and white, then color

On social, each set of posts walks through a client's journey in black and white photos, from the first search to signing the documents. The final post lands on a single color photo at the moment of success.

Because the rest of the feed stays black and white, that one color photo is the post people stop on, and it gives the whole set a payoff.



JOURNEY · BLACK AND WHITE

Neutral tones, crushed blacks and slightly lifted contrast, with no tints or grain.



SUCCESS · FULL COLOR

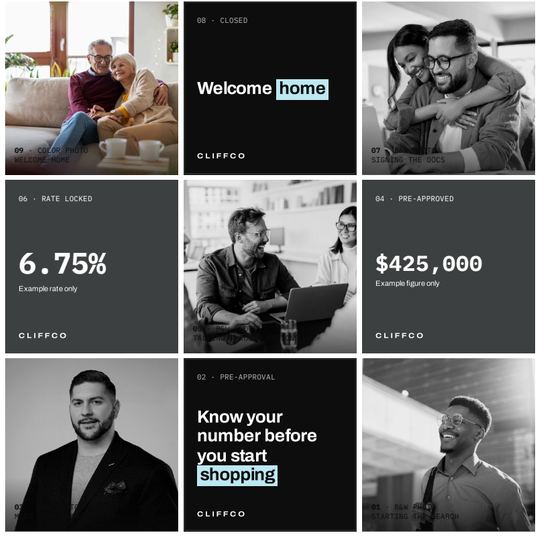
No more than one color photo in each set of nine posts.

PHOTOGRAPHY ON SOCIAL

The grid

Photos sit in a checkerboard with black caption tiles and graphite figure tiles, so no two photos sit side by side. Only the caption tiles use the Sky box.

Instagram shows the newest post first, so the color photo is the last post published in each set, which puts it at the top left of the grid. The numbers show posting order, starting from 01 at the bottom right.



SOCIAL

Covers, thumbnails and posts

Every cover is built the same way: the photo, the caption in its fixed position, and the wordmark top right. On 9:16, keep type 13% off the top and 18% off the bottom, clear of the app's own controls.

SURFACE	SIZE	CAPTION	POSITION	MARK
YouTube thumbnail	1280 × 720	72–96 px	Lower left, baseline 12% up	Wordmark top right, 180 px wide
Reels · Shorts cover	1080 × 1920	88–110 px	Lower left, baseline 24% up	Wordmark top right in the safe area
Feed post	1080 × 1350 · 1080²	80–100 px	Lower left, baseline 10% up	Wordmark top right, 150 px wide
Story	1080 × 1920	88–110 px	Inside the safe area	Wordmark or name tag, not both
Link preview	1200 × 627	64–80 px	Lower left	Wordmark top right, 170 px wide
Profile avatar	1080 × 1080	None	None	CMB icon, centered

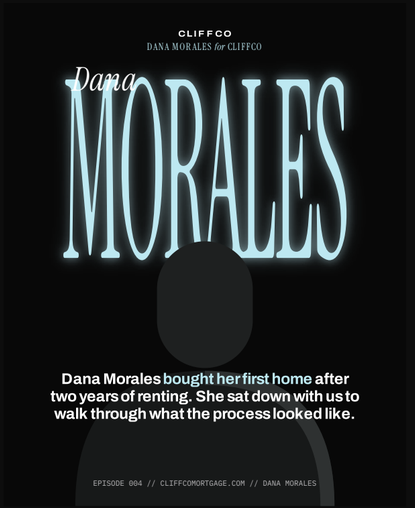
STUDIO AND GALLERY POSTS

The name on the wall

For interviews, client stories and guest episodes shot on a studio set, Cliffco uses the family's editorial system: a tall Sky serif name behind the subject, numbered quote slides, mono name tags, and B-roll that floats as a glowing screen.

Face	Instrument Serif Regular, capitals, –0.02 em, Sky
Size	80% of the frame width, then stretched vertically only until the caps stand 40% of the frame height
Position	Cap line 10–12% from the top; the subject stands in front of the lower half
Glow	Outer glow in Sky, 1.5% of the frame width, 50–55% opacity
Accent	First name in Instrument Serif Italic, white, over the top left of the big name
Hook	Archivo Bold at 3.9% of the width, one phrase in Sky; Plex Mono footer at 95%

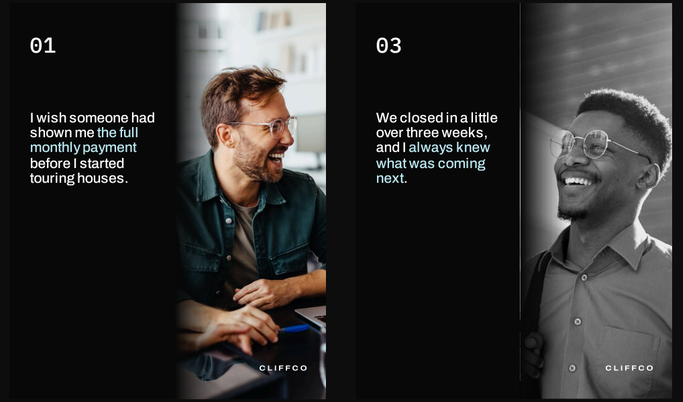
Names and quotes in this section are samples.



Gallery slides

Every slide after the cover is one thought on one photo, and the number counts the thoughts. The quote is Archivo Medium at 3.9% of the frame width, flush left on a 6.5% margin, no wider than 37% of the frame.

1. The numeral is IBM Plex Mono at 6.7% of the width, top left.
2. One phrase per slide goes Sky; the wordmark sits bottom right.
3. Alternate color and black and white photos so the carousel breathes. The type never changes.



Title cards, B-roll and name tags



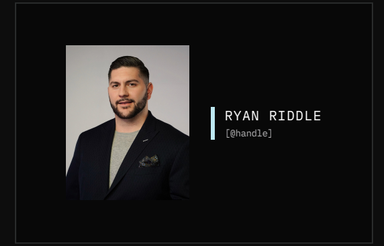
Title card

A Sky tab at the left edge, CLIFFCO in Archivo Bold beside the guest's name in Instrument Serif Italic, and credits in Soft Gray. The tab is the only color on the card.



B-roll on the floating screen

Nothing cuts away while someone is talking. Footage floats above the table in a 16:9 panel 76% of the frame wide, with a thin Sky edge and soft glow.



Name tag

IBM Plex Mono capitals with a Sky bar on the left, the handle underneath in Soft Gray. It marks who is speaking or who is in the photo.

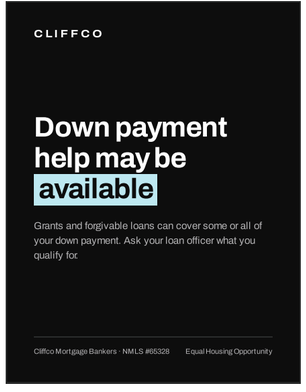
Where it applies: interviews, client stories, loan officer features and the carousels cut from them. **Where it doesn't:** everyday posts, rate updates, print and the logo, which never takes the serif, the stretch or the glow.

PRINT

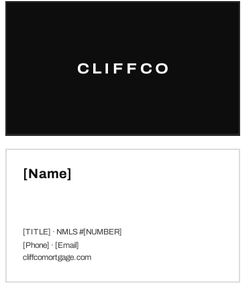
Black field, white type, one Sky word

Print follows the screen. The field is black, the headline is white, and dense information moves to a white panel in black type.

1. Margins of 6% of the short edge; type flush left and ragged right.
2. Rich black on large fields, 100% K on small type, 0.125 in bleed on every black-field piece.
3. White type at 9 pt or larger when reversed out of black.
4. Sky is C22 M0 Y5 K0 as a starting build, proofed before the run; light tints shift on uncoated stock. No Sky on business cards.
5. Every flyer carries the NMLS number and the Equal Housing Opportunity logo.



FLYER · LETTER



BUSINESS CARD · FRONT AND BACK

QUICK REFERENCE

Before you post or print

BEFORE YOU POST

- ☐ Caption 2–6 words, Archivo Bold, white
- ☐ Exactly one word in the Sky box, in black
- ☐ Caption in the same position on every cover
- ☐ Wordmark top right, or a name tag, never both
- ☐ Social photos in black and white, one color payoff per set
- ☐ Studio covers: name at 80% width, caps at 40% height, Sky glow

BEFORE YOU PRINT

- ☐ Archivo installed; wordmark at 700, 112.5% width, +200
- ☐ Rich black fields, 100% K small type
- ☐ Sky proofed from C22 M0 Y5 K0
- ☐ White type 9 pt or larger when reversed
- ☐ 0.125 in bleed, 6% margins
- ☐ NMLS number and EHO logo on every piece

CLIFFCO

We make financing simple

Archivo · Instrument Serif
IBM Plex Mono

CMB

Thank *you*.

Click. Funded.